

uninstall and reinstall the application. When you are browsing through the folder for images, the application first scans the entire folder. If you have a lot of images on your PC, this process can take up quite some time.

Xnview takes up 10 MB of space on your PC, but with

Price: Freeware
Web site: www.xnview.com

the kind of file support it offers, it is worth it.

SPECIFICATIONS

2.4 MB download file, takes up 10 MB disk space, Windows 9X/2000/XP

Xnview		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	

Logitech optical mouse

Easy on the hands

This USB mouse is lightweight, good looking and easy to install. The package also provides a USB to PS/2 adapter, which can be handy if your PC does not have a USB interface. Apart from this, the package includes the MouseWare CD supporting almost all the operating systems available today (Windows 95/98 SE/2000/XP and various versions of Linux) along with a user manual that explains how to use the mouse without straining your hand. Using the software provided on the CD, you can change mouse pointers,



speed, refresh rate, etc for the device. The wire that connects the mouse is long enough and the device itself feels comfortable to use. Since it's an optical mouse, you can use it on any surface. The roller button however feels a bit tacky.

SPECIFICATIONS

USB interface 1.1

Logitech optical mouse		B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	

Price: Rs 1,200
Contact: Rashi Peripherals
Phone: 022-8260256
Fax: 022-8221012
E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com
Web site: www.rptechindia.com

Olivetti OFX580

M for multifunctional

The Olivetti OFX580 is targeted at SoHo users who would like to have a one-stop solution for their basic day-to-day office chores. The device is a printer, scanner, fax machine, copier and a telephone, all rolled into one. It occupies very little space on your desktop and sports good looks too. The buttons are well placed and



colour-coded. The telephone supports caller identification and hands-free dialling. The package includes the Linkfax software, using which you can scan and mail files directly from the application. There's an LCD panel on the front of the device, which is handy if you want to check the status of the device—whether it's printing, faxing or copying.

Going by our tests, the quality of the black and white prints is quite good and so is the performance of the scanner and copier, but the colour printouts are of average qual-

Price: Rs 19,100
Contact: Spice Net Limited
Phone: 022-6122419/6132165
Fax: 022-6122419
E-mail: ro_mum@spicenetindia.com

Nishubuki Desknote A900

Desktop power with notebook mobility

Unlike other notebooks, Nishubuki Desknote A900 packs enough power to be considered as a desktop replacement. Sporting a 1 GHz Pentium III mobile processor and 192 MB RAM, it ensures sufficient power for most office applications.

But when running several applications simultaneously, the performance was sluggish, as seen in the two main tests that we ran, namely, Content Creation and Business Winstone. Here it generated scores of 13.5 and 14.1 respectively, which was less than what we expected (the average score for PCs with similar specifications is around 20 points in both tests).

Communications is taken care of by a V.90 56 Kbps modem and a 10/100 Mbps LAN adapter. For users seeking to attach external devices, the Desknote has four USB ports. The TV-out function

ity. Hence, if you need to print heavy graphics, this device is not a good option. Barring Windows 95 and 98, it does not support any other operating systems, which narrows down its usability.

SPECIFICATIONS

Printing: 300 dpi in black and white, 600 dpi in colour, 2.6 ppm in black and white and 1 ppm in colour
Scanning: black and white scanning at 200x200 dpi with 64-bit grey scale mode
Faxing: 7 seconds to scan at 14,400 bps
Copying: 2 copies per minute; maximum 140 per cent zoom

Olivetti OFX580		B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	



lets you make business presentations or watch movies on a larger screen. The display system comprises a 14.1-inch XGA TFT screen supporting a maximum resolution of 1024x768 with a built-in SiS 64 MB (shared memory) 3D graphics card.

The external Ni-MH battery is a novel concept and helps reduce the weight of the Desknote. However, the external battery drained out in 33 minutes in the Battery-Mark 4.01 test.

All in all, the Desknote is